

AILEEN C. LUO

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Research

- AOS:** Kant, Early Modern, History and Philosophy of Psychology (esp. theories of learning and development)
- AOC:** Post-Kantian Philosophy, Philosophy of Mind, Philosophy of Cognitive Science and AI, Philosophy of Law

Education

- (2027) **Stanford University** | Ph.D. in Philosophy
Dissertation: “Genetic Epistemology in Kant’s Psychological Philosophy”
Committee: Allen Wood (co-advisor), Lanier Anderson (co-advisor), David Hills, Thomas Icard
- Stanford University** | Ph.D. minor in Psychology
Certificate in Data Science
- 2017 **University of Oxford** | B.Phil., *Distinction*
- 2015 **Tufts University** | M.A., Philosophy
- 2012 **University of Hong Kong** | P.C.I.LL., *Practising certificate in laws*
- 2010 **University of Cambridge** | LL.M.
- 2009 **City University of Hong Kong** | LL.B., *First class honours*

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- 2026 “Omissions, the Act Requirement, and Criminal Liability”
Criminal Law and Philosophy

Manuscripts under Review

- In preparation* “Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation”
▪ Winner of the 2025 *Markus Herz Prize*

Work in Progress

- Drafted* “A Sense of Time: Kant on Locke on Temporal Representation”
- Drafted* “Kant’s Acquisition Theory of the Categories”

<i>In progress</i>	“Kant on Stupidity”
<i>In progress</i>	“Condillac on Learning to Perceive”
<i>In progress</i>	“Sophie de Grouchy on the Education of Affect”
<i>In progress</i>	“Agentic Affordance: Why LLMs Invite the Intentional Stance” (with Knut W. Gu)

Awards and Fellowships

2025	Markus Herz Prize (awarded for the best graduate student paper by the North American Kant Society)
2025	Society for Philosophy and Psychology Travel Award
2023	Patrick Suppes Dissertation Fellowships
2019	Full Funding for Summer School on Neo-Kantian Philosophy, Chinese University of Hong Kong
2018	Thomas Mardenbro Benson Scholarships
2018	Language Study Grant (\$10,000 for German language study in Berlin)
2013	Tufts University MA Scholarships
2006	Chung Hwa Travel Service Scholarships
2006	School of Law Legal Practice Manuals Prizes
2005-06	Chan Tai Ho Scholarships (for best academic performance in cohort)
2005	HSBC Scholarships for Academic Excellence (for best academic performance across the university)

Presentations

Refereed

2026	“Agentic Affordance: Why LLMs Invite the Intentional Stance” (with Knut W. Gu) 6 th International Conference on Philosophy of Mind: Artificial Intelligence (ICPH), University of Porto
2025	“Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation” North American Kant Society Midwest Study Group, University of Notre Dame
2025	“Recognizing Opportunities for Learning: Limitations of Predictive Processing from a Kantian Perspective” Talk presented at the Society for Philosophy & Psychology, Cornell University
2023	“Grounding Kant’s Categories” Ethics and Politics, Ancient and Modern Workshop, Stanford University
2022	“Kant’s <i>I think</i> ” Conference on Self and Embodiment, Trinity College Dublin

- 2019 “Cassirer and Kant on Perception”
13th International Kant Congress, Oslo
- 2018 “Omissions, the Act Requirement, and Criminal Liability”
Berkeley-Stanford-Davis Graduate Conference
- 2016 “Voluntariness, Duress, and Culpability”
Workshop on Knowledge, Reasons and Action, Erlangen
University
- 2016 “Space and Apperception in the B-Deduction”
2nd Kant in Asia International Conference, Hong Kong Baptist
University

Departmental

- 2025 “Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation”
Graduate Workshop on Kant’s Philosophy, UC Berkeley
- 2024 “Kant’s Acquisition Theory of the Categories”
Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University
- 2024 “Kant’s Acquisition Theory of the Categories”
Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University
- 2022 “Leibniz and Kant on the Human Mind”
Kant Retreat, Stanford University
- 2022 “Kant’s *I think*”
Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University
- 2021 “Kant’s *I think*”
Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University
- 2016 “Space and Apperception in the B-Deduction”
Ockham Society, University of Oxford

Invited

- Upcoming* Discussant, *A Conference in Honour of Allen W. Wood and Rega Wood*
Department of Philosophy, Stanford University

Comments

- 2025 On *Autism, Schizophrenia and Predictive Processing: Some Lessons for Perceptual Epistemology* by Timothy Butzer
American Philosophical Association, Pacific Division

Teaching

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Guest Lecturer

2025 Kant's First Critique

Sole Instructor

2026 Other People's Minds
 2023 Theories of Consciousness in Early Modern Philosophy

Teaching Assistant

2026 Philosophy of Mind
 2026 Introduction to Moral Philosophy
 2025 Plato and Punishment
 2025 Introduction to Moral Philosophy × 2
 2025 Introduction to Philosophy
 2024 Introduction to Moral Philosophy
 2024 Modern Philosophy
 2023 Modern Philosophy
 2022 Minds and Machines
 2021 Modern Philosophy
 2020 Mind, Matter, and Meaning
 2019 Minds and Machines
 2019 Modern Philosophy
 2018 Mathematical Logic

TUFTS UNIVERSITY

Teaching Assistant

2014 Logic

Pedagogical Training

2022 Preparing for Faculty Careers Seminar, Office of Vice Provost for Graduate Education, Stanford University
 2018-19 Teaching Methods Seminar, Philosophy Department, Stanford University

Professional Service

2025 Referee, Society for Philosophy and Psychology conference submissions
 2022 Mentor, Philosophy Directed Reading Program, Stanford University
 2021-22 Organizer, Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University
 2021-22 Organizer, Kant Reading Group, Stanford University
 2019-20 Coordinator, Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University

Referee for: *Aggressive Behavior*

Languages

Natural languages: Mandarin (native), Cantonese (fluent), English (fluent), German (reading)

Programming/IT: MATLAB, Python

Professional Affiliation

American Philosophical Association
North American Kant Society
Society for Philosophy and Psychology

References

Allen Wood
Professor (Emeritus)
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

David Hills
Associate Professor
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Lanier Anderson
Professor
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Greg Wong-Taylor (teaching)
Lecturer
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Dissertation Description

Title: “Genetic Epistemology in Kant’s Psychological Philosophy”

Abstract:

My dissertation investigates the origins of *a priori* cognition in Kant’s critical philosophy. Against the widespread view that Kant understood *a priori* cognition as an innate endowment of the human mind, I argue that even our most fundamental representations—space, time, and the categories—are not simply given but are acquired through the autonomous exercise of reason. Drawing on Kant’s engagements with Berkeley, Locke, and Leibniz, as well as insights from developmental psychology, I develop a *genetic* model of the *a priori* that explains how the mind comes to construct its own forms of intuition and concept under self-imposed constraints. On this view, Kant emerges as an anti-nativist of a distinctive kind, rejecting both divine and natural preformation in favor of a conception of cognition grounded in epistemic agency and justification. What ultimately distinguishes human cognition, then, is not a set of preformed dispositions, but the capacity to develop and exercise cognitive faculties through an ongoing, rational process of self-determination.